14 *Ibid.*

Deliberations at the Round Table Conferences

1 Self governance or self rule.

2 FICCI passed a resolution to boycott the first Round Table Conference on G.D. Birla's insistence. Both Lala Sri Ram and Purshotamdas had wanted FICCI to attend and Birla's attitude caused an open division in FICCI's leadership. They feared that while the government would take care of European interests the Indian interests would go unrepresented. In the event, Sir Homi Mody, President of the Bombay Mill-owners' Association officially represented Indian business. Birla was also there, but on a strictly unofficial basis.

3 Purshotamdas first met Gandhi in 1920 as the Sheriff of Bombay when he paid Gandhiji a courtesy call at the house of his host Ravishankar Jagjivan, a jeweller who resided at Gamdevi, Bombay.

4 Quoted in Aditya Mukherjee, *Imperialism, Nationalism and the Making of the Indian Capitalist Class*, 1902–1947, Sage Publications Pvt. Ltd, New Delhi, 2002, pp. 67–68.

5 Frank Moraes, *Sir Purshotamdas Thakurdas*, Asia Publishing House, Bombay, 1957, p. 199.

6 In Hindu mythology, a divine 'cow of plenty' which is said to provide her owner whatever he desires.

7 Frank Moraes, *Op.Cit.*, p. 199.

8 This should not lead the reader to believe that Purshotamdas was a tightfisted man. On the contrary he gave freely and generously to various causes throughout his life. One can only infer that political donations did not appeal to him.

9 Frank Moraes, *Op.Cit.*, p. 199.

10 *Ibid.*, p. 201.

11 Purshotamdas had purchased this palatial mansion on the brow of Malabar Hill on the celebrated Ridge Road from J.R.D. Tata. It had been built by his father, R.D. Tata, for the family and named after Sooni his wife. Purshotamdas' wife evinced interest in the property